

YEAR 10 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 4 · ADVERTISING

Reading

B1+/B2

The Anatomy of a Slogan · Buy Now, Think Later?

Hazırlık Sonrası 10. Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Understand the main idea and details, make inferences and connect the text to your own life.

1 Before you read

Make predictions before you read.

1. Look at the title. What do you think 'the anatomy of a slogan' means?
2. Can you remember any advertising slogan or jingle by heart? Why do you think it stuck in your memory?

The Anatomy of a Slogan

- 1 Open any magazine or scroll through any app, and within seconds an advertisement will try to catch your eye. Behind every slogan, though, lies a surprising amount of psychology. Copywriters choose each word with care, often building a campaign around adjectives that grow gradually stronger — good, then great, then unbeatable — so that a product always sounds just a little more exciting than its rivals. A soap might be described first as 'gentle', then, a line later, as 'incredibly gentle', while a competitor's soap is quietly dismissed as merely 'ordinary'.
- 2 Words are only half the story. Many successful campaigns also rely on a jingle — a short, catchy tune that sticks in a listener's memory long after the advert has finished. Researchers who study consumer behaviour say that a jingle heard often enough becomes almost impossible to forget, even years later. This is no accident: advertisers deliberately repeat both the tune and the slogan across television, radio and social media, hoping that familiarity will eventually turn into trust.
- 3 Not everyone is convinced that this approach is entirely honest. Critics argue that stacking one impressive adjective on top of another can mislead shoppers into expecting more than a product can actually deliver. For this reason, many schools now teach media literacy, encouraging young consumers to ask a simple question before they buy: is this slogan describing the product, or just describing a feeling the advertiser wants me to have?

239 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What is the main idea of the text?
 - ☐ a Slogans are chosen randomly by advertisers.
 - ☐ b Advertisers carefully choose increasingly strong words and repeat jingles to influence consumers.
 - ☐ c Jingles are no longer used in modern advertising.
2. Copywriters often build a campaign around adjectives that grow _____ across the text.
3. According to the text, why do advertisers repeat a jingle across many platforms?
 - ☐ a To make it illegal for rivals to copy
 - ☐ b To make it hard for actors to remember their lines
 - ☐ c To build familiarity that can turn into trust
4. According to the text, all critics believe slogans are completely honest. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
5. Many schools now teach _____ to help young consumers question adverts.

3 After you read*Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.*

1. Do you think exaggerated slogans are a harmless part of advertising, or a kind of dishonesty? Why?

2. Think of a product. Write one 'plain' and one 'exaggerated' slogan for it.

1 Before you read*Make predictions before you read.*

1. What do you think the title 'Buy Now, Think Later?' suggests about advertising?

2. Do you think adverts affect your own spending decisions? Give an example.

Buy Now, Think Later?

- 1 It is widely believed that advertising simply informs consumers about new products, but psychologists argue that its real power lies elsewhere. Adverts are said to work by creating an emotional connection — with happiness, status or the fear of missing out — long before the shopper consciously considers whether they actually need the item. By the time reasoning takes over, an emotional decision may already have been made.

- 2 This idea troubles many economists, who point out that entire populations can be nudged toward spending patterns that don't always serve their own interests. Families are sometimes encouraged, through relentless advertising, to blow money on the latest gadget rather than put aside savings for less exciting but more important goals. It is claimed that low-income households are particularly vulnerable, since a single well-timed advertisement can outweigh weeks of careful budgeting.
- 3 Not all commentators are so pessimistic, however. Some argue that advertising, used responsibly, helps a population make informed comparisons between products, and that today's consumers are far less gullible than earlier generations assumed. Whichever view is correct, most agree on one thing: understanding how an advert is trying to persuade you is the first step toward deciding, calmly, whether to reach for your wallet.

202 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

- What is the main idea of the text?
 - Advertising only gives factual information about products.
 - Advertising can influence emotions and spending before reasoning takes over, which raises concerns for some commentators but not all.
 - All economists agree that advertising should be banned.
- Adverts are said to work by creating an _____ connection before reasoning takes over.
- According to the text, all commentators believe advertising is harmful. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
- According to the text, who is claimed to be particularly vulnerable to well-timed advertisements?
 - Retired shoppers
 - Low-income households
 - Company shareholders
- The text suggests that families are sometimes encouraged to _____ money on gadgets rather than save it.

3 After you read

Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.

- Do you agree that some groups of people are more vulnerable to advertising than others? Why or why not?

- What is one thing you could do before buying something you saw advertised?

